

Robert Finan

🏠 Drogheda, Co. Louth, Ireland

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in LinkedIn

EDUCATION

Trinity College Dublin

2022 – 2026

BA Mathematics & Philosophy (Single Honours Philosophy Pathway)

- **First Class Honours.**
- Coursework spanning formal logic, mathematical proof, set theory, philosophy of language, philosophy of mind, metaphysics, epistemology, ethics, aesthetics, moral psychology, history of philosophy (esp. Ancient Greek), probability and statistics; elective modules in chemistry and literary theory.

Dublin City University (DCU)

2019 – 2020

Early University Entrance

- Completed modules: Electrical Engineering, Materials Engineering, Mathematical Sciences.

Centre for Talented Youth Ireland

2016 – 2019

Various Courses

- Completed courses: Theoretical Physics, Computer Sciences, Advertising & Marketing, Robotics, Cryptanalysis, Medicine & Microbiology.

Drogheda Grammar School

2016 – 2022

Leaving Certificate (Terminal Secondary School Examination)

- Leaving Certificate: 625 CAO points (Maximum).
- Differential Aptitude Tests (DATs) Standardised Testing: 99th percentile.
- Subjects: Applied Mathematics, Art, Computer Science, English, History, Irish, Mathematics, Physics.

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

Published

- “Believing Without Desiring, Desiring Without Believing: Against the Motivation Argument for Desire As Belief” – *GUA Library*, 2026.
- “Against ‘Framelessness’ in Environmental Aesthetics” – *GUA Library*, 2026.
- “The Misguided Debate Over Existential Import” – *Trinity Student Philosophical Review IV*, 2026.
- “Dogma at the Limits of Thought” – *Daedalus I*, 2026.
- “Reassessing Cantorian Cardinality” – *Trinity Student Philosophical Review III*, 2025.

Under Review & In Preparation

- “The Significance of Peirce for Infinite Set Theory”.
- “Conceptual Idealism Is Not Metaphysical: Hofweber on Facts and Effability”.
- “Imagination and Modal Knowledge: Defending Kripke from Hill”.
- “Early Wittgenstein’s Alleged Solipsism”.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- **Global Winner in Philosophy (Thomas Clarkson Medal)** – *Global Undergraduate Awards*, 2026. Top entry internationally for paper: “Against ‘Framelessness’ in Environmental Aesthetics”.
- **Highly Commended** – *Global Undergraduate Awards*, 2026. Top 10% globally for paper: “Believing Without Desiring, Desiring Without Believing”.
- **Entrance Exhibition Award** – Trinity College Dublin.
- **All Ireland Mathematics Award** – Irish Mathematics Teachers Association.
- **Award for Visual Art & Community Contribution** – Drogheda Grammar School.

CONFERENCES & SEMINARS

* = Refereed † = Invited

“Preserving Functionality in Ambiguity-Motivated Debates in Logic” * [Poster] <i>Universality and Indifference: Is Logic Neutral?</i> , LMU Munich, Germany	Nov 2026
“The Significance of Peirce for Infinite Set Theory” * <i>17th International Conference – World Philosophy Day</i> , University of Prishtina, Kosovo	Nov 2026
GUA Global Summit , Royal Irish Academy, Dublin	Nov 2026
• “Against ‘Framelessness’ in Environmental Aesthetics” †	
• “Against the Motivation Argument for Desire As Belief” * [Poster]	
“A Case for Adding Philosophy to Ireland’s Leaving Certificate” * <i>Oxford Philosophical Society & Maynooth Inaugural Conference</i> , Maynooth University	Nov 2026
“Conceptual Idealism and the Language-Metaphysics Gap” * <i>Logic of Metaphysics</i> , Universität Potsdam, Germany	Sep 2026
“Plato’s Good is Not a Form” * [Unable to attend (funding)] <i>SOPhiA</i> , University of Salzburg, Austria	Sep 2026
“The Misguided Debate Over Existential Import” † [Unable to attend (funding)] <i>9th World Congress on the Square of Opposition</i> , UQAM, Montréal	Jun 2026
Imagination Day [Attendee] – University of St Andrews	May 2026
The Non-Conference [Attendee] – Queen’s University Belfast	May 2026
Philosophy of Mathematics [Attendee] – Université de Lille	Jun 2025

TEACHING & MENTORING

Representative, Olympiad Judge, & Philosophy Coach <i>Modus Ponens Institute</i>	August 2026 – Present
• Conduct outreach, teach secondary school students, and judge international Olympiads.	
Freelance Mathematics, Philosophy & Logic Tutor <i>Self-employed (GoStudent, SuperProf, FindTutors, AFEPI)</i>	2022 – Present
• One-to-one and group tutoring; students aged 6–21, including neurodiverse learners.	
• Primary and Junior Cycle Mathematics, Leaving Certificate Mathematics, and undergraduate Philosophy and Formal Logic.	
Residential Assistant <i>Centre for Talented Youth Ireland (CTYI)</i>	July 2023
• Supervised and mentored academically gifted students on CTYI’s residential summer programme, organised activities and events, provided academic and pastoral support.	
Mentor & Prefect – <i>Drogheda Grammar School</i>	2021 – 2022
Cinnire (Mentor) – <i>Campa Gaeilge</i>	August 2019

ACADEMIC SERVICE & EXTRACURRICULAR

Founder & Director <i>Philosophy for the Leaving Certificate</i>	July 2026 – Present
• Independently authored a policy proposal for introducing Philosophy as a Leaving Certificate subject in Ireland, built a campaign website, an international petition, and a primary research survey.	
• Proposal raised in Seanad Éireann (Upper House of Irish Parliament).	

English Language Editor

July 2026 – Present

MetaScientia: Journal of the History and Philosophy of Science (peer-reviewed, open-access)

- Edit accepted manuscripts for English-language grammar and clarity ahead of publication.

Other Extracurriculars

- **The Irish Philosophical Society** – Member Dublin, Ireland.
- **The Metaphysical Society** – Member & *Daedalus* Contributor Trinity College Dublin.
- **The Philosophical Society (Phil)** – Member Trinity College Dublin.
- **The Historical Society (Hist)** – Member Trinity College Dublin.
- **All Ireland Linguistics Olympiad** – Competitor Dublin City University.
- **Dublin 22** – Invited Participant Common Purpose Ireland.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The following roles were concurrent with full-time study to support and independently fund my degree.

MiriamSimon.ie – Digital Media Writer & Editor 2018 – Present

Gerry's Fresh Foods – Sales Assistant 2024 – 2025

Saba To Go – Front of House Staff 2022 – 2024

O'Sullivan's Safety – Receptionist / Administrative Assistant 2021 – 2022

Choice – Sales Assistant 2019 – 2021

Internships: Accenture, Arup, ExitEntry, Indaver (temporary placements) 2019 – 2020

CERTIFICATIONS & SKILLS

- **Language, Proof and Logic**, Stanford University, Online – Certified.
- **Classroom Strategies for Inquiry-Based Learning**, University of Texas Austin, Online – Audited.
- **Paradox and Infinity**, MIT, Online – Audited.
- **Technical:** $\text{\LaTeX}$, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Data Entry & Analysis.
- **Compliance:** Garda Vetted; Tusla – Children First; Manual Handling Certificate.
- **Creative:** Graphic Design; Copywriting; Oil Painting; Sculpture.

ACADEMIC REFERENCES

Prof. John Divers diversj@tcd.ie

Professor of Moral Philosophy & Head of Philosophy | Trinity College Dublin

Prof. James Levine jlevine@tcd.ie

Associate Professor of Philosophy | Trinity College Dublin

Prof. Vasilis Politis vpolitis@tcd.ie

Professor of Philosophy | Trinity College Dublin

Dr. Richard Teague richard.teague1@ucd.ie

Postdoctoral Fellow in Philosophy | University College Dublin

Dr. Tom Farrell tfarrell@rcsi.ie

Surgeon Prosector, Anatomy and Regenerative Medicine | Royal College of Surgeons Ireland